📘 MGT503 – Lesson 35
Other Need & Cognitive Theories of Motivation
🔹 Lecture Summary (Exam-Oriented)
1. McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y
Theory X: Employees dislike work, avoid responsibility, are lazy; must be coerced.
Theory Y: Employees are creative, seek responsibility, capable of self-direction.
Connection to Maslow:
Theory X → lower-order needs dominate.
Theory Y → higher-order needs dominate.
2. Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory
Intrinsic factors → job satisfaction and motivation.
Extrinsic factors → dissatisfaction if absent.
Two categories:
Hygiene factors (prevent dissatisfaction): pay, working conditions, supervision, company policies, benefits.
Motivators (increase satisfaction/motivation): achievement, responsibility, recognition, work itself, growth.
3. ERG Theory (Clayton Alderfer)
Simplifies Maslow into three need categories:
Existence: material/physiological desires (food, pay, working conditions).
Relatedness: relationships with others (family, coworkers, professional groups).
Growth: creativity, innovation, personal productivity.
Key principles:
Satisfaction-progression: fulfilling one level encourages concern for next level.
Frustration-regression: failure to satisfy higher needs → focus may return to lower-level needs.
ERG theory allows simultaneous focus on multiple needs.
4. McClelland's Acquired-Needs Theory
Needs are learned through life experiences.
Measured via Thematic Apperception Test (TAT).
Three types of needs:
Achievement (nAch): desire to accomplish challenging tasks, excel.
Affiliation (nAff): desire for warm, friendly relationships.
Power (nPow): desire to influence/control others.
Personal power: dominance for self-interest.
Institutional power: influence to achieve organizational goals.
Successful managers' profile: moderate-high institutional power, moderate achievement, minimum affiliation.
5. Cognitive Perspectives – Equity Theory
Developed by J. Stacey Adams.
Employees compare inputs vs. outcomes with relevant others (referents).
Perceived inequity → employee may:
Distort own or others' inputs/outcomes.
Act to change own or others' inputs/outcomes.
Change comparison referent.
Quit the job.
Significance for Managers

Need theories highlight importance of higher-order needs for motivation.
Individuals differ in need structures → managers must personalize motivation strategies.
ERG's frustration-regression principle has implications for handling unmet needs.
Understanding equity perception is crucial for fairness and employee retention.
📝 20 MCQs (VU Paper Pattern)
1. Theory X assumes employees:
A. Are creative and responsible
B. Dislike work and avoid responsibility
C. Always seek self-actualization
D. Prefer autonomy
✅ B
2. Theory Y assumes employees:
A. Must be coerced
B. Seek responsibility and self-direction
C. Are lazy
D. Avoid higher-order needs
✅ B
3. Herzberg's hygiene factors are:
A. Intrinsic motivators
B. Extrinsic factors that prevent dissatisfaction
C. Factors that increase job satisfaction
D. None of the above
✅ B
4. Motivators in Herzberg's theory include:
A. Salary and company policy
B. Achievement and recognition
C. Working conditions and supervision
D. Job security
✅ B
5. ERG theory stands for:
A. Existence, Relatedness, Growth
B. Effort, Reward, Goal
C. Equity, Responsibility, Growth
D. Experience, Recognition, Gratification
✅ A
6. Existence needs in ERG theory include:
A. Relationships and teamwork
B. Pay, working conditions, physiological needs
C. Creativity and innovation
D. Recognition and achievement
✅ B
7. Relatedness needs focus on:
A. Material resources
B. Relationships with family, coworkers, and professional groups
C. Personal achievement
D. Job satisfaction
✅ B
8. Growth needs in ERG theory are associated with:

A. Creativity, innovation, personal productivity
B. Job security
C. Affiliation with coworkers
D. Physiological needs
✅ A
9. ERG theory differs from Maslow's theory because:
A. Only focuses on physiological needs
B. Allows focus on multiple needs simultaneously
C. Ignores growth needs
D. Disregards relatedness
✅ B
10. McClelland's need for achievement (nAch) is:
A. Desire for friendly relationships
B. Desire to accomplish challenging tasks
C. Desire for power over others
D. Desire for security
✅ B
11. Need for affiliation (nAff) is:
A. Desire to dominate others
B. Desire to maintain warm relationships
C. Desire for financial rewards
D. Desire to innovate
✅ B
12. Need for power (nPow) is divided into:
A. Intrinsic and extrinsic
B. Personal and institutional
C. Maslow and Herzberg
D. Safety and esteem
✅ B
13. According to McClelland, successful managers usually have:
A. High need for affiliation only
B. Moderate-high institutional power, moderate achievement, minimal affiliation
C. High personal power
D. Low need for achievement
✅ B
14. Equity theory suggests employees compare:
A. Job title only
B. Inputs vs. outcomes with relevant others
C. Salary only
D. Skills with coworkers
✅ B
15. A possible response to perceived inequity is:
A. Quit the job
B. Adjust own inputs/outcomes
C. Ask others to change inputs/outcomes
D. All of the above
✅ D
16. Herzberg believed that removing dissatisfaction factors:

A. Always increases motivation
B. Does not necessarily make a job satisfying
C. Reduces motivation
D. Eliminates the need for recognition
✅ B
17. Theory X aligns with:
A. Higher-order needs
B. Lower-order needs
C. Growth needs
D. Self-actualization
✅ B
18. Theory Y aligns with:
A. Maslow's higher-order needs
B. Physiological needs only
C. Hygiene factors
D. Existence needs
✅ A
19. ERG theory's frustration-regression principle states:
A. Satisfaction of lower needs prevents higher needs
B. Failure to satisfy higher needs may redirect focus to lower needs
C. Individuals cannot satisfy multiple needs
D. Only growth needs matter
✅ B
20. Acquired-needs theory emphasizes that needs are:
A. Innate and unchangeable
B. Learned through life experiences
C. Only physiological
D. Only safety-related
✅ B